



Your Questions, Our Answers

Things going “boom” when they shouldn’t be?

Too Much Sound

Q You said in your February issue that VirtualDub can extract audio from video. It did extract audio, but only from AVI files. Also, the size of the audio files is too large (the same size as the video) and is stored in the WAV format. I want to convert WAV to MP3 and to reduce its size so I can store it on my MP3 player.

Aayush Shrut

A You can certainly compress the audio in the AVI to not only MP3, but to any of the installed audio codecs. After you open the AVI file in VirtualDub, click on Audio and select Full processing mode. Go to Audio > Compression (which was greyed out earlier), and select the compression codec from the left in the Select audio compression window.

Going Retro

Q My XP computer has a weird problem—it produces the Ding.wav sound for the default system beep through the internal speaker rather than my external speakers. How can I correct this?

Anand Prakash

A Open the Registry Editor and go to HKEY_CURRENT_USER\AppEvents\Schemes\Apps\.Default\.Default\.Current and edit the default string value to %SystemRoot%\media\Windows XP Ding.wav. Go to HKEY_CURRENT_USER\AppEvents\Schemes\Apps\.Default\.Default\.Default and edit the default string value to %SystemRoot%\media\Windows XP Ding.wav.

Not Quite Picture-Perfect

Q I bought the Leadtek Winfast TV-Tuner card (which *Digit* recommended) a few months ago. Picture quality is not up to the mark, and there is a lot of noise and patterns in the video. The card works perfectly well when I install it on a friend's PC.

Sameer Malhotra

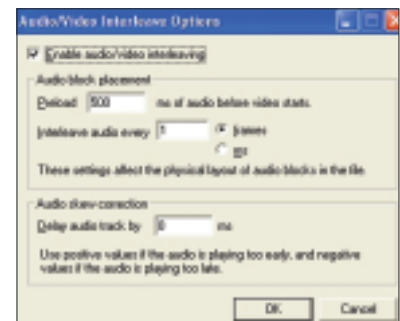
A The picture quality of the TV-Tuner is affected by many things. Since it is an internal TV-Tuner, the PC's internal electromagnetic radiation is often a major culprit. Try to install the TV-Tuner in the last PCI slot so it is far from any other card. You also need to pay attention to the wiring. Make sure you solder all the joints with the plugs. There should be a minimum number of joints as there is a huge signal strength drop at each joint, and this drastically affects video quality. And last, check if your cable TV signal strength is strong enough (compare your TV channel's image quality with that at your friend's place), and if it is not so, contact your cable operator to get it remedied.

Imperfect Harmony

Q The AVI file I converted my home videos to have the audio and video out of sync.

Sunil Verekar

A You can easily correct this problem using VirtualDub. Open the file in VirtualDub and select Audio > Interleaving. In the Audio/Video Interleaving options window, enter a value for Delay audio track by in milliseconds. Enter a positive value if the audio plays too early and negative if plays too late. This is a trial-and-error method, and you may need to click on the Output Play button to view if the value you provided is correct.



Set the audio video synchronisation in VirtualDub

Cam To Comp

Q I have a DV Cam and want to create a DVD using the captured contents. What hardware and software is needed?

Deepak Negi

A To connect your DV Cam to your PC, your PC should have a FireWire port. If it doesn't have one, you can easily get a PCI card that will let you add one for around Rs 750. There are two major chipsets available, ask the vendor for a card with NEC chipset as it is generally found to be better. Next, you need a FireWire cable (if one didn't come with your DV Cam, you can get one for around Rs 200). Make sure that the cable and the FireWire ports (on your DV Cam and PC) are compatible with each other: there are two types of FireWire ports—one is with 4 pins and is smaller, the other one has 6 pins and is larger. Your DV Cam must have come with a video editing software that will recognise your DV Cam and let you edit and transfer the captured content to your hard drive. If it hasn't, or if you are dissatisfied with the bundled application, you can use Nero Vision, which is a part of Nero 8 Ultra Edition. You can download a copy of this software from www.nero.com, or check if it has been bundled with your DVD-Writer, which is again another necessary piece of hardware.

You need at least a 2 GHz processor, at least 1 GB of RAM, and a hard drive with at least 20 GB of free space to let you store as well as edit the captured video. ■

Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@jasubhai.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!